

GAMING MONITORS

FOR YOUR EVERYDAY GAMING NEEDS



Acer Predator XB271HK

Price: ₹51,500



Gaming panels didn't evolve much this year. We mostly saw more panels adopting higher refresh rates but in terms of innovation, there wasn't much of note this year. The highest refresh rate for gaming monitors is still 240 Hz and going higher isn't going to add much to one's experience. Essentially, we're saying that higher refresh rate monitors have become more affordable. Then there's the ongoing adaptive-sync battle between FreeSync and G-Sync that seems to be favouring the former. We've also seen more sales of curved monitors but it continues to remain a measly fraction of the overall sales figures for this category. More games on the

PC and console are increasingly incorporating HDR and to cater to this demand, we've seen more manufacturers offer monitors with HDR support but these continue to be on the expensive side of the spectrum.

2018 ZERO1 AWARD WINNER Acer Predator XB271HK

The Acer Predator XB271HK is an extremely popular gaming monitor at the moment. It's not a high-refresh rate monitor but the AHVA panel on the XB271HK is very good and it has support for G-sync. Given that the market is dominated by NVIDIA cards at the moment, this monitor makes for a great accompaniment. After all, the whole point of getting a high refresh rate monitor is to enjoy fluid visuals and having an adaptive sync monitor does just that. There's also the fact that the AU Optronics panel used in the XB271HK supports true 10-bit colour depth. If you were to put all of these aside, then the primary factor why the XB271HK won this year's Zero1 Award for the best gaming monitor is its low input lag of approximately 4 milliseconds. It also has one of the lowest average fE values from all the gaming monitors we've tested so far, so the victory is well deserved.

RUNNER-UP BenQ EL2870U

BenQ's EL2870U is being marketed by BenQ as an entertainment monitor. So that doesn't make it a true gaming monitor but we took a look at the hardware to judge it ourselves. It's not a true 10-bit panel but an 8-bit panel with FRC. This makes it closer to an 8-bit panel than to a 10-bit panel. That being said, it has a response time of 1 ms owing to the TN panel used. Not only that, even the input lag is very low but not enough to beat the Acer Predator XB271HK. 



BenQ EL2870U

Price: ₹30,510